

OWNLY ONCE

CREDIT READINESS KIT

VOLUME 03 OF SIX



YOUR 90 DAY CREDIT READINESS WORKBOOK

A practical plan for your reports,
payments, and progress.

COMPLIMENTARY FIELD GUIDE

itsownlymoney.com

03 / 06

FIELD GUIDE

Build a process you can repeat

Use this workbook to organize your next 90 days of credit review and financial readiness. Your work runs on two tracks: correcting inaccurate information and managing the accounts and payments you have today.

What you will build

- A baseline set of reports and a clear financial goal.
- An evidence file for each reporting issue.
- Factual disputes and a record of responses.
- A payment plan and scheduled progress reviews.

Ninety days is an organizational framework, not a promise of results. Investigations follow their own receipt dates and legal requirements. You can dispute errors yourself without purchasing an app or service.

This workbook provides general education, not individual legal or financial advice. For litigation, bankruptcy, or an urgent housing issue, seek qualified help.

ROADMAP

Your 90 day roadmap

Period	Focus	Output
Days 1 to 7	Establish your starting point	Saved reports, goal, and due-date list.
Days 8 to 14	Prepare and send supported disputes	Letters, evidence, and delivery records.
Days 15 to 45	Maintain payments and track investigations	Updated tracker and stable payment routine.
Days 46 to 60	Review responses	Targeted next actions for unresolved errors.
Days 61 to 90	Follow through and reassess	Updated reports and next-month plan.

Adjust this schedule to the actual dates your disputes are received. Some reviews may finish earlier; other issues may take longer. Avoid sending repetitive letters simply because a calendar block has ended.

FIELD GUIDE

Set up your private working file

- Save each credit report with the bureau name and report date.
- Create a folder for each disputed item, with separate records for each reporting company.
- Keep statements, payment receipts, settlement letters, and prior responses together.
- Store sensitive identity documents securely and share only through verified channels.
- Use a tracker or calendar to record actions and receipt dates.

Suggested folder order

Folder	Keep here
01 Reports	Starting and updated reports.
02 Evidence	Documents supporting your exact claim.
03 Sent	Final letters and attachments.
04 Delivery	Tracking numbers and submission confirmations.
05 Responses	Investigation results and follow-up decisions.

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Get your baseline reports

Use AnnualCreditReport.com to access reports through the official site. Follow its identity-verification instructions. Save each report before making comparisons.

Review each reporting company separately

- Personal details and unfamiliar identity information.
- Open and closed accounts, account ownership, and status.
- Balances, credit limits, payment history, and important dates.
- Collections, charge-offs, and inquiries.
- Any public-record information that appears.

A missing account at one bureau is not automatically an error. Companies may supply information to different bureaus or on different schedules.

Reports saved and dates

Accounts needing a closer look

FIELD GUIDE

Find the exact issue

Field	Question to investigate
Identity	Does the account belong to me? Is there evidence of a mixed file?
Balance	Does the amount match current statements or a completed settlement?
Payment history	Which month is wrong, and what record shows the correct payment?
Status	Does the record correctly describe paid, settled, open, closed, or transferred?
Dates	Am I comparing the same kind of date on each report?
Duplicate reporting	Is the same obligation actually duplicated, or are the creditor and collector reporting different roles?

Different dates may describe different events. A recent update date alone does not establish that a debt has been improperly made newer.

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Connect the claim to evidence

Write a sentence that another person can investigate: what the report says, why you believe it is wrong, and what the record should show.

Illustrative example

The report lists a \$420 balance. My attached completion letter states that the settlement was satisfied on June 12. Please investigate and update the remaining balance to reflect the completed settlement.

Issue	Useful records
Incorrect payment month	Statement and payment confirmation.
Wrong paid or settled balance	Agreement, payment record, and completion letter.
Wrong person or suspected identity theft	Relevant identity records and genuine identity theft report, if applicable.
Wrong court disposition	Official docket, dismissal, satisfaction, or court order.

My claim in one sentence

My strongest supporting document

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Choose the right recipient

A credit reporting company compiles the report. A furnisher supplies account information. A debt collector may also have separate obligations when contacting you about a debt.

Issue	Where to begin
Error in a credit report	Dispute with each reporting company showing the error; contact the furnisher about the incorrect information it supplied.
Debt collection notice	Read the validation notice and response deadline. Debt validation is distinct from a bureau dispute.
Tenant screening error	Identify the screening company in the adverse action notice or report.
Actual identity theft	Use IdentityTheft.gov and the relevant reporting-company process.

Follow the recipient's designated dispute process and identification requirements. Do not mail sensitive documents to an address found only in an old template.

CUSTOMIZABLE LETTER

Your first factual dispute

Use for a specific error shown in your current report.

[Your full name]

[Mailing address]

[City, State ZIP]

[Date]

[Reporting company name]

[Designated dispute mailing address]

Re: Reporting error for [account or item identifier]

I am disputing the following information in my report dated [date], confirmation number [number, if available].

The report states: [exact field and value]. I believe this is inaccurate or incomplete because [specific explanation]. The correct information is [correction supported by your records].

I have enclosed [documents] supporting my dispute. Please review these records and conduct a reasonable reinvestigation. Correct the inaccurate information or delete information that cannot be verified, as appropriate.

Please send me the written investigation results and an updated report reflecting any changes.

Sincerely,

[Your signature or name]

Enclosures: [List enclosed copies]

BEFORE YOU SEND

Prepare and send your packet

- Replace every bracketed field. Remove statements that do not match your experience.
- Use the company's current official dispute address or online process.
- Identify the disputed account and explain the exact error, the supporting facts, and the correction requested.
- Include copies of relevant documents. Keep your originals. Supply identifying information according to the recipient's requirements.
- Save the completed letter and every attachment. For mailed disputes, certified mail with a return receipt can document delivery.
- Record receipt and response dates. Review the result before deciding on a follow-up.

These templates are educational tools for factual, good-faith disputes. They are not legal advice and do not promise deletion, a score increase, funding, or housing approval.

Current bureau instructions

[Equifax dispute instructions](#)

[Experian dispute instructions](#)

[TransUnion dispute instructions](#)

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Track the investigation correctly

A reporting-company reinvestigation generally runs from receipt of your dispute, commonly 30 days, with up to 45 days in certain circumstances. Written results are generally provided within five business days after completion.

Record events rather than assumptions

- Date sent and date received by the reporting company.
- Confirmation number and any requests for more information.
- Date you provided additional material, if any.
- Date and content of the investigation result.
- Whether the updated report actually resolves your claim.

A request for the description of a completed reinvestigation procedure has a separate 15-day response rule under 15 U.S.C. 1681i(a)(7). It is not a 15-business-day automatic deletion rule.

See the statutory reference in the resources section for conditions and exceptions.

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Read the result before following up

Result	What to do
Corrected or deleted	Save the result and check the updated report.
Partially corrected	Identify the exact field still wrong and the evidence supporting it.
Verified or unchanged	Review the explanation; request the investigation procedure if useful and provide relevant new detail.
More identification needed	Respond through the verified company channel.
Frivolous or insufficient dispute notice	Read the reason and provide the missing specifics if you still have a factual dispute.
No response after the applicable period	Confirm receipt, preserve the timeline, and consider the current complaint process.

More rounds do not automatically make a dispute stronger. A useful follow-up addresses what the response missed.

FIELD GUIDE

Handle each account on its facts

Collections and charge-offs

Review the owner, balance, status, and dates. A charge-off is an accounting treatment; it does not by itself cancel a debt. Payment or settlement does not automatically remove accurate history.

Late payments

Compare the exact months with payment records and written accommodations. If the history is accurate, focus on future payments rather than submitting a false dispute.

Inquiries

Investigate unfamiliar names and the relevant application or account review. Dispute an inquiry when you have a genuine reason to believe it was improper, not simply because a card application was declined.

Special situations

For bankruptcy, lawsuits, old debts, or identity theft, use advice and procedures appropriate to the situation. Do not let a general workbook replace a time-sensitive legal response.

WORKSHEET

Build your monthly payment plan

Start with essential living expenses and required payments. Set a sustainable extra-payment amount and keep enough cash to avoid another missed payment.

Account	Due date	Minimum	Planned payment

Monthly amount available after essentials

Extra payment amount I can sustain

Day I review account balances each week

Automatic payments can help, but check the account balance and confirm each payment posts.

FIELD GUIDE

Use new credit selectively

Before adding a secured card, credit-builder product, or reporting service, compare costs, eligibility, reporting coverage, and the payment commitment.

- Ask which reporting companies receive the information.
- Check fees, deposit requirements, cancellation terms, and whether late payments are reported.
- Do not assume rent or utility reporting affects every score or every lender.
- Choose a product only if it fits your needs and budget.
- Keep using existing accounts responsibly while an error is investigated.

Application decision

What problem would this new account solve?

What is the total cost?

What is my reason to proceed or wait?

WORKSHEET

Your dispute record

Make one copy for each item and reporting company. Keep this page with the report, evidence, letter, delivery confirmation, and response.

Reporting company and report date

Account or case identifier

Exact reporting error

Evidence and requested correction

Date sent and delivery date

Dispute confirmation or tracking number

Response date and result

Remaining issue and next action

WORKSHEET

Your day 90 review

Measure	Starting point	Current position
Reported card balances		
Missed payments since starting		
Errors corrected		
Disputes still unresolved		
Payment routine established		
Next financial goal		

If you compare scores, use the same source, scoring model, and bureau where possible. A change in the displayed score is not proof that a single action caused it.

What worked and what I will continue

My next action and review date

RESOURCES

Sources and next steps

Reference links checked September 14, 2026. Use the official resources below for current instructions and details.

AnnualCreditReport.com | Official report access

[Open resource](#)

CFPB | Disputing a credit report error

[Open resource](#)

FTC | Disputing errors on your credit reports

[Open resource](#)

15 U.S.C. 1681i | Reinvestigation procedures

[Open resource](#)

CFPB | When a debt collector contacts you

[Open resource](#)

CFPB | Credit reporting complaint requirements

[Open resource](#)

Put your next move on the calendar

Visit **itsownlymoney.com** to explore Ownly ONCE financial readiness coaching and complete the assessment. Bring your goals and a list of questions; keep sensitive report documents in a secure channel.

Explore Ownly ONCE and start your assessment

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